The Hindu
EDITORIAL ANALYSIS

30th January 2025

PREPARE FOR BANK (PO/ CLERK), SSC,UPSC, State PSC, CAT,CTET,RAILWAY EXAMS,CDS, TET, NDA/AIRFORCE, NET and all Govt. Exams

VOCABULARY

1. Augment (वृद्धि करना)

Meaning: To increase or make something larger or more substantial.
Synonyms: Increase, enhance, expand
Antonyms: Decrease, reduce, diminish
Example: The workers used the MGNREGS to augment their income during the agricultural off-seasons.

2. Intricacy (जटिलता)

Meaning: The quality of being complex and detailed, often requiring careful attention.
Synonyms: Complexity, elaboration, detail
Antonyms: Simplicity, plainness, straightforwardness
Example: The intricacy of the cybercrime investigation required the expertise of several specialists.

VOCABULARY

3. Anonymization (गुमनाम बनाना)

Meaning: The process of removing identifying details to make something anonymous.
Synonyms: Masking, obscuring, concealing
Antonyms: Identification, revealing, exposure
Example: The company used anonymization techniques to protect users' personal data from being exposed.

4. Pruning (काट-छांट)

Meaning: The act of reducing or trimming something, especially in terms of resources or budgets.
Synonyms: Cutting, trimming, reducing
Antonyms: Expanding, increasing, growing
Example: The company began pruning its expenses to stay profitable during the recession.

VOCABULARY

5. Resilience (दृढ़ता)

Meaning: The ability to recover quickly from difficulties; toughness.
Synonyms: Toughness, endurance, fortitude
Antonyms: Fragility, weakness, vulnerability
Example: The resilience of the community helped it rebuild after the devastating flood.

6. Ubiquitous (सर्वव्यापी)

Meaning: Present, appearing, or found everywhere.
Synonyms: Everywhere, omnipresent, pervasive
Antonyms: Rare, scarce, uncommon
Example: Smartphones have become ubiquitous in modern society, with almost everyone owning one.

VOCABULARY

7. Ephemeral (क्षणिक)

Meaning: Lasting for a very short time.
Synonyms: Fleeting, short-lived, transient
Antonyms: Permanent, enduring, lasting
Example: The beauty of the sunset was ephemeral, disappearing as quickly as it arrived.

8. Sapient (ज्ञानी)

Meaning: Having or showing great wisdom or discernment.
Synonyms: Wise, sagacious, insightful
Antonyms: Foolish, ignorant, unwise
Example: The sapient leader guided the nation through its most difficult times with clarity.

VOCABULARY

9. Innocuous (निर्दोष)

Meaning: Not harmful or offensive.
Synonyms: Harmless, benign, safe
Antonyms: Harmful, dangerous, offensive
Example: The comment seemed innocuous at first, but it caused an unexpected uproar.

10. Sporadic (विपरीत, कभी-कभी होने वाला)

Meaning: Occurring at irregular intervals or only in a few places; scattered or isolated.
Synonyms: Intermittent, occasional, scattered
Antonyms: Regular, constant, frequent
Example: The rain was sporadic throughout the day, with heavy showers followed by clear skies.

VOCABULARY

Phrasal Verbs:

1. Dob in
Meaning – To inform on someone or report their wrongdoing.

2. Ebb away
Meaning – To gradually decrease or fade away.

3. Hack off
Meaning – To cut something off roughly or to annoy someone greatly.

4. Zip by
Meaning – To pass quickly or speed past.

VOCABULARY

Idioms & Phrases

1. Queer the pitch

Meaning - Spoil a plan

2. Vanish into thin air

Meaning - Disappear completely

3. Cool as a cucumber

Meaning - Very calm and composed

VOCABULARY

4. Down in the dumps

Meaning - Feeling depressed

5. Hit the books

Meaning - Start studying seriously

Article for Reading

Handling cybercrimes through public-private partnership model

In recent years, cybercrimes have skyrocketed, becoming one of the most pressing challenges for governments, organisations, and individuals worldwide. According to a report by Cybersecurity Ventures, cybercrime is projected to cost the global economy a staggering $10.5 trillion annually by the end of 2025, up from $3 trillion in 2015. This exponential rise is fuelled by the increasing sophistication of cyberattacks, ranging from ransomware and data breaches to phishing and identity theft. The rise of cybercrime has affected law enforcement agencies globally and India is no exception. Police forces are facing significant challenges as they grapple with the evolving nature of cyber threats and the increasing complexity of investigating and preventing cybercrimes. The sheer volume of cybercrimes in India, as recorded in the recent NCRB's Crime in India, is overwhelming. Fraud, hacking, identity theft, online harassment, digital arrest, investment app frauds and child exploitation are just a few of the types of cybercrimes that law enforcement agencies must contend with.

Each crime presents its unique challenges and requires specialised knowledge and tools. The complex nature of cybercrimes adds layers of intricacy to investigations, often involving multiple jurisdictions, encryption, anonymization, and sophisticated attack vectors. Government and Police cannot alone contain the growing menace of cybercrimes and the IT industry also cannot handle it alone. Hence the solution is to ensure the collaboration of the Government with the private sector and academia to conform with the rapidly-changing technological world. A collaborative strategy like the Public-Private Partnership (PPP) model is essential to address the growing complexities of cybercrime. The National Cyber Security Policy of India also affirms in developing effective PPP models. The PPP model allows for the pooling of resources, expertise, and technologies, enabling faster detection, response, and prevention of cyberattacks. By working together, stakeholders can share real-time threat intelligence, enhance cybersecurity infrastructure, and foster a unified approach to creating a resilient digital environment.

To put in place an institutionalized structure for an effective capacity building of cybercrime investigations, the CID Karnataka, in collaboration with Infosys Foundation and Data Security Council of India (DSCI), set up the Centre for Cybercrime Investigation Training & Research (CCITR) at the Criminal Investigation Department (CID) headquarters, Bengaluru, in 2019. CCITR is one of its kind of public-private partnership aimed at improving the investigation and prosecution of cybercrime cases. As part of this collaboration, DSCI plays the role of knowledge partner and Infosys Foundation as the funding partner. This centre has been instrumental in combatting cybercrimes through training, research, and collaboration. The Centre continue to contribute significantly to the Karnataka Police's efforts to train police, prosecution, judiciary and other departments in handling technology investigations and create standard operating procedures (SOPs) in cybercrime investigations.

Summary

The passage discusses the rising threat of cybercrimes, which have become a significant challenge for governments, organizations, and individuals worldwide. The global economic cost of cybercrime is expected to reach $10.5 trillion annually by the end of 2025. In India, law enforcement agencies are facing difficulties in addressing various types of cybercrimes, such as fraud, hacking, identity theft, and online harassment. The complexity of these crimes demands specialized knowledge and collaborative efforts. The solution lies in a Public-Private Partnership (PPP) model that combines government, private sector, and academia resources to combat cyber threats. The Centre for Cybercrime Investigation Training & Research (CCITR) in Bengaluru, set up in 2019, is an example of such collaboration. It plays a vital role in training law enforcement personnel and improving the investigation and prosecution of cybercrime cases.

Tone:
The tone of the passage is informative and formal. It emphasizes the seriousness of the growing cybercrime issue, the need for collaboration, and the positive impact of the public-private partnership approach in addressing these challenges.

Reading Comprehension

Based on the above passage, answer the following questions:

Question 1:
Which of the following is a challenge faced by law enforcement agencies in India with respect to cybercrime?

a) The rise in the number of police personnel specializing in cybercrimes.
b) The inability of private companies to help in investigating cybercrimes.
c) The lack of laws to prosecute cybercriminals.
d) The increasing volume and complexity of cybercrimes.
e) None of the above

Question 2:
Which of the following statements about the Public-Private Partnership (PPP) model is true based on the passage?

a) It is a model that exclusively involves the private sector.
b) It is a model where the government takes complete responsibility for cybersecurity.
c) It is a model that facilitates resource sharing, expertise, and technology to combat cyberattacks.
d) It limits participation to only law enforcement agencies.
e) None of the above

Article for Skimming

Stifling demand: on the MGNREGS

The efficacy of a welfare programme is directly proportional to the enthusiasm of the government implementing it. The Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Scheme (MGNREGS) will soon be completing 20 years of its implementation. The fact that it has not only survived but also thrived under two regimes across multiple terms suggests its utility and popularity among the rural poor, though, under the National Democratic Alliance, the scheme has acquired a status of being an unwanted necessity after being seen initially as someone else's baby. But as the COVID-19 pandemic showed, the MGNREGS was a necessity and vital in terms of the sustenance it provided to both rural workers and migrant labour returning to their rural homes after the lockdowns were announced. And it is fair to say that it is now seen as "unwanted", as allocations in percentage terms of consecutive Budgets have reduced substantially since the pandemic (from 3.2% in FY21 to 1.78% in FY25 (BE)).

Besides, despite the fact that the scheme is demand driven, inevitably leading to the allocation of additional funds beyond the budgeted expenditure, no extra allocation for MGNREGS has been made this financial year even as wages have been delayed and, due to this, demand also suppressed artificially. Reportedly, the Rural Development Ministry was short of ₹4,315 crore for the wages and the Centre has a liability of ₹5,715 crore against its share for material component of the works to be done under the scheme. There are other issues with MGNREGS implementation that require attention — the need to adjust wages to inflation, and the issues concerning the seeding of job cards with the Aadhaar-based payment system, among others. But the core of the scheme remains the adequacy of the allocations made for it by the Centre.

By pruning funds, the purpose of providing demand-driven employment is under-served and it is unfair to rural workers across the country who have used the scheme to augment their incomes, especially in the agricultural off-seasons. There has been much academic study detailing the fruits of the scheme — from helping the destitute to creating village assets such as irrigation canals, rural roads, and water conservation facilities. A demand-driven exercise such as this scheme also puts disposable income in the hands of the village poor and helps the rural economy. The importance of MGNREGS in a country still facing rural poverty needs no elaboration. The Union government must change its attitude towards the MGNREGS. A substantial allocation in the Union Budget, that is true to the demand for the scheme, would be a good start.

Question 3:
What does the passage suggest about the recent budget allocations for MGNREGS?

a) Budget allocations have remained consistent over the years, reflecting government commitment.
b) Allocations have increased significantly to meet rising demand.
c) Allocations in percentage terms have decreased since the pandemic, despite continued demand.
d) The government has allocated funds exactly matching the demand for the scheme.
e) None of the above

Question 4:
What does the passage suggest about the role of MGNREGS in the rural economy?

a) It discourages rural workers from seeking full-time employment.
b) It increases disposable income among the rural poor and helps sustain the rural economy.
c) It has led to excessive government expenditure with minimal economic benefits.
d) It primarily benefits urban businesses rather than rural workers.
e) None of the above

Question 5:
What is the passage's main recommendation regarding the future of MGNREGS?

a) The government should phase out MGNREGS and replace it with a more efficient program.
b) The scheme should be privatized to improve efficiency.
c) MGNREGS should focus more on urban employment rather than rural employment.
d) A substantial budget allocation should be made to reflect actual demand.
e) None of the above

Today's Descriptive Question:

Original Text:

In the business world, a unicorn refers to a privately held startup company valued at over $1 billion. The term was coined by venture capitalist Aileen Lee in 2013 to highlight the rarity of such companies, similar to the mythical creature. Unicorns are typically technology-driven startups that experience rapid growth due to innovative business models, disruptive technologies, and significant venture capital investments. Unicorns are found across various industries, including fintech, e-commerce, artificial intelligence, and healthcare. Companies like Uber, Airbnb, and Stripe achieved unicorn status by revolutionizing traditional industries and scaling their businesses globally.

These startups often prioritize growth over immediate profitability, attracting investors willing to take high risks in exchange for potentially massive returns.

The rise of unicorns is driven by factors such as increased digital adoption, a surge in venture capital funding, and globalization, which enables startups to reach a broader customer base. However, despite their high valuations, many unicorns face challenges such as intense competition, regulatory scrutiny, and sustainability concerns. Some struggle to maintain profitability or face market corrections that reduce their valuations.

While unicorns symbolize success and innovation, their long-term sustainability depends on strong business fundamentals, effective leadership, and adaptability to market changes. As the startup ecosystem evolves, companies must balance rapid expansion with financial stability to remain competitive in the global market.

Precis:

A unicorn is a privately held startup valued at over $1 billion, known for rapid growth and innovation, particularly in technology-driven industries. Companies like Uber and Airbnb achieved unicorn status by disrupting traditional markets and attracting significant venture capital.

The rise of unicorns is fueled by digital adoption, venture funding, and globalization, but challenges like competition, regulatory issues, and profitability concerns persist. Long-term success depends on strong business strategies, leadership, and financial sustainability.

- **Write an email to the head of an educational institution applying for a scholarship. Provide details about your academic achievements, financial situation, and reasons for applying.**

To: ……@gmail.com

Subject: Scholarship Application Request

Dear [Head of Institution's Name],

I hope you are well. I am [Your Name], a [Your Course/Program] student at [Your Institution's Name], seeking financial assistance through a scholarship.

I have maintained a strong academic record, achieving [mention key achievements], and actively participated in [mention relevant extracurriculars]. However, financial constraints pose a challenge to continuing my education. This scholarship would ease my burden and allow me to focus on my studies.

I have attached the required documents for your review.

Please let me know if any additional information is needed.

Thank you for your time and consideration. I look forward to your response.

Best regards,
[Your Name]
[Your Contact Information]

Match the column

1. Queer the pitch	A. Very calm and composed
2. Vanish into thin air	B. Feeling depressed
3. Cool as a cucumber	C. Start studying seriously
4. Down in the dumps	D. Spoil a plan
5. Hit the books	E. Disappear completely

Answer:

1-d

2-e

3-a

4-b

5-c

Vocabulary

1. Augment:
2. Intricacy:
3. Anonymization:
4. Pruning:
5. Resilience:
6. Ubiquitous:
7. Ephemeral:
8. Sapient:
9. Innocuous:
10. Sporadic:

Rc ans

1.

Ans: d

Explanation:

Reference: "Police forces are facing significant challenges as they grapple with the evolving nature of cyber threats and the increasing complexity of investigating and preventing cybercrimes."

The passage emphasizes that the main challenge for law enforcement is the increasing volume and complexity of cybercrimes, which require specialized knowledge and tools.

Incorrect Options:

a) Incorrect since the number of specialists is not mentioned as a challenge, but rather the complexity and volume of cases.

b) Incorrect as the issue is not a lack of private company involvement but the complexity of the crimes themselves.

c) Incorrect because the challenge is not the lack of laws, but rather the complexity of investigations.

2.
Ans: c
Explanation:
Reference: "The PPP model allows for the pooling of resources, expertise, and technologies, enabling faster detection, response, and prevention of cyberattacks."

The PPP model is explicitly described as facilitating resource sharing, expertise, and technology to improve the detection and prevention of cyberattacks.

Incorrect Options:

a) Incorrect because the PPP model involves collaboration between the public and private sectors, not just the private sector.
b) Incorrect because the government does not take complete responsibility, but shares the burden with the private sector.
d) Incorrect because the PPP model includes more than just law enforcement agencies; it involves multiple stakeholders.

3.

Ans: c

Explanation:

Reference: "Allocations in percentage terms of consecutive Budgets have reduced substantially since the pandemic (from 3.2% in FY21 to 1.78% in FY25 (BE))."

The passage highlights that the budget allocation for MGNREGS has decreased from 3.2% in FY21 to 1.78% in FY25 (BE). Despite being demand-driven, no extra allocation has been made, leading to wage delays and artificially suppressed demand.

Incorrect Options:

a) Incorrect as the passage explicitly states that budget allocations have decreased.

b) Incorrect because the government has reduced allocations rather than increasing them.

d) Incorrect since the scheme is demand-driven, but the government has not matched allocations with demand.

4.
Ans: b
Explanation:
Reference: "A demand-driven exercise such as this scheme also puts disposable income in the hands of the village poor and helps the rural economy."

The passage mentions that MGNREGS puts disposable income in the hands of the village poor, which supports the rural economy, particularly during agricultural off-seasons.

Incorrect Options:

a) Incorrect because the scheme supplements rural incomes, not discourages full-time employment.
c) Incorrect as the passage highlights positive economic benefits, not excessive expenditure.
d) Incorrect since the scheme directly benefits rural workers, not urban businesses.

5.

Ans: d

Explanation:

Reference: "The Union government must change its attitude towards the MGNREGS. A substantial allocation in the Union Budget, that is true to the demand for the scheme, would be a good start."

The passage argues that the Union government must change its attitude towards MGNREGS and allocate funds in the budget that align with the actual demand of the scheme.

Incorrect Options:

a) Incorrect because the passage supports MGNREGS rather than suggesting its replacement.
b) Incorrect because there is no mention of privatization.
c) Incorrect since the scheme is meant for rural employment, and there is no suggestion to shift focus to urban jobs.

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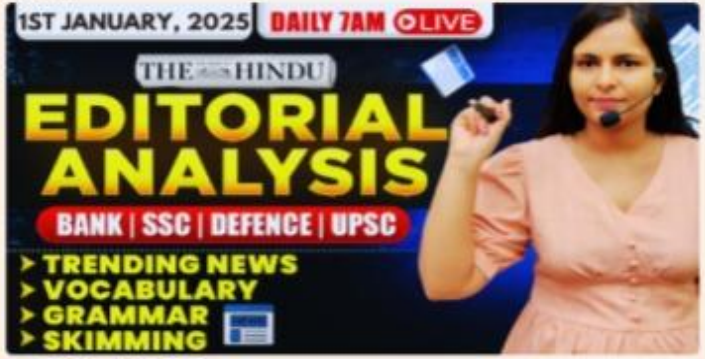

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